# SSC CHSL 2020 Tier-I question paper with answers

**11 August 2021 · Shift 2**

66 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 34 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20211105175401/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/FinalAnswerKeys_%20CHSLE2020_05112021.pdf

## English Language 24 questions

**Q.1**

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

**(A)** Recurrent
**(B)** Dilemma
**(C)** Unpretensious
**(D)** Excellence

**Q.2**

Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the right order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph. A. This cooled off into darkness after a few million years. B. The first time was when the universe began its existence as a glowing fireball. C. In the modern scientific story, light was created not once but twice. D. The second time was when the cold material condensed into dense nuggets and ignited to become the first stars.

**(A)** DBAC
**(B)** CBAD
**(C)** ABCD
**(D)** BADC

**Q.3**

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in reported speech. The new employee asked the manager, "When do I have to report for work?"

**(A)** The new employee told the manager that when he had to report for work.
**(B)** The new employee asked the manager when he had to report for work.
**(C)** The manager told the new employee when to report for work.
**(D)** The new manager asked the employee when he would report for work.

**Q.4**

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Appalling

**(A)** Awesome
**(B)** Tremendous
**(C)** Fantastic
**(D)** Shocking

**Q.5**

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'. We have finished our work for the day, so “let we go home” early today.

**(A)** No substitution required
**(B)** let us go
**(C)** let ours go
**(D)** let our go

**Q.6**

Select the most appropriate word to fill in the blank. When you speak, there are gestures and body language that _____ your words.

**(A)** achieve
**(B)** accomplish
**(C)** accompany
**(D)** construct

**Q.8**

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in the active or passive voice. Fifteen children were rescued from an unregistered home by the police.

**(A)** The police rescued fifteen children from an unregistered home.
**(B)** Fifteen children rescued the police from an unregistered home.
**(C)** The police were rescued fifteen children from an unregistered home.
**(D)** The police have rescued fifteen children from an unregistered home.

**Q.9**

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. To fish in troubled waters

**(A)** To take advantage of a difficult situation
**(B)** To try to find a big catch in the deep sea
**(C)** To try to do something that is very difficult
**(D)** To catch fish in stormy weather in the sea

**Q.10**

Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the right order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph. A. This means that decisions should not be taken under any kind of pressure to benefit individuals or only a small section of society. B. First, there should be transparency in making decisions; secrecy breeds corruption. C. There are certain values that civil servants need to imbibe in themselves for better administration. D. Then, all decisions must be taken only in public interest, to benefit the community at large.

**(A)** CADB
**(B)** CBDA
**(C)** DABC
**(D)** BADC

**Q.11**

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Gloomy

**(A)** Dull
**(B)** Bright
**(C)** Catchy
**(D)** Dismal

**Q.12**

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Trail

**(A)** Rehearsal
**(B)** Glory
**(C)** Path
**(D)** Win

**Q.13**

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. Although we had / very good batsmen, / we couldn't be able to / score high.

**(A)** score high
**(B)** Although we had
**(C)** we couldn't be able to
**(D)** very good batsmen

**Q.14**

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A quick, sudden movement

**(A)** Flick
**(B)** Fleck
**(C)** Dust
**(D)** Speck

**Q.15**

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. Only five minutes / are allowed / for each speaker / during the function.

**(A)** for each speaker
**(B)** Only five minutes
**(C)** are allowed
**(D)** during the function

**Q.16**

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Curt

**(A)** Impolite
**(B)** Polite
**(C)** Dismal
**(D)** Rude

**Q.17**

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'. You “must return back” the book you borrowed last month.

**(A)** must be returned
**(B)** must return
**(C)** No substitution required
**(D)** must be returned back

**Q.18**

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A busy, main road for public use

**(A)** Thoroughfare
**(B)** Promenade
**(C)** Avenue
**(D)** Highway

**Q.19**

Select the most appropriate word to fill in the blank. Schools will restart physical classes partially and states have _____ their own conditions and procedures to ensure the safety of students.

**(A)** accepted
**(B)** devised
**(C)** insisted
**(D)** adopted

**Q.20**

Select the most appropriate meaning of the idiomatic expression given. At a stone’s throw

**(A)** Beat someone with a stone
**(B)** Throw a stone at someone
**(C)** At a very short distance
**(D)** Like throwing a stone

**Q.21**

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. What are the future possibilities for space travel in the long term? (1) _____ will humans go after they have explored our solar system? It is said that 'Star Trek' could hold the (2) _____ to these questions. It is predicted that travel to other galaxies will only be (3) _____ in huge 'starships'. These will wander through space for hundreds or even thousands of years. Each of them will carry a large human (4) _____. Some of those people will take over a suitable new planet and settle down there. This search for new planets to settle in will continue until life on planet Earth could be just a (5) _____ memory.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

**(A)** Where
**(B)** Why
**(C)** How
**(D)** When

**Q.22**

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. What are the future possibilities for space travel in the long term? (1) _____ will humans go after they have explored our solar system? It is said that 'Star Trek' could hold the (2) _____ to these questions. It is predicted that travel to other galaxies will only be (3) _____ in huge 'starships'. These will wander through space for hundreds or even thousands of years. Each of them will carry a large human (4) _____. Some of those people will take over a suitable new planet and settle down there. This search for new planets to settle in will continue until life on planet Earth could be just a (5) _____ memory.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

**(A)** query
**(B)** answer
**(C)** door
**(D)** solution

**Q.23**

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. What are the future possibilities for space travel in the long term? (1) _____ will humans go after they have explored our solar system? It is said that 'Star Trek' could hold the (2) _____ to these questions. It is predicted that travel to other galaxies will only be (3) _____ in huge 'starships'. These will wander through space for hundreds or even thousands of years. Each of them will carry a large human (4) _____. Some of those people will take over a suitable new planet and settle down there. This search for new planets to settle in will continue until life on planet Earth could be just a (5) _____ memory.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

**(A)** imagined
**(B)** possible
**(C)** implemented
**(D)** achieved

**Q.24**

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. What are the future possibilities for space travel in the long term? (1) _____ will humans go after they have explored our solar system? It is said that 'Star Trek' could hold the (2) _____ to these questions. It is predicted that travel to other galaxies will only be (3) _____ in huge 'starships'. These will wander through space for hundreds or even thousands of years. Each of them will carry a large human (4) _____. Some of those people will take over a suitable new planet and settle down there. This search for new planets to settle in will continue until life on planet Earth could be just a (5) _____ memory.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

**(A)** instinct
**(B)** colony
**(C)** proportion
**(D)** population

**Q.25**

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. What are the future possibilities for space travel in the long term? (1) _____ will humans go after they have explored our solar system? It is said that 'Star Trek' could hold the (2) _____ to these questions. It is predicted that travel to other galaxies will only be (3) _____ in huge 'starships'. These will wander through space for hundreds or even thousands of years. Each of them will carry a large human (4) _____. Some of those people will take over a suitable new planet and settle down there. This search for new planets to settle in will continue until life on planet Earth could be just a (5) _____ memory.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

**(A)** distant
**(B)** imaginary
**(C)** nearest
**(D)** factual

## General Intelligence 17 questions

**Q.1**

In a certain code language, 'UMBRELLA' is written as 'VNCSDKKZ' and 'FASTENED' is written as 'GBTUDMDC'. How will 'MONUMENT' be written in that language?

**(A)** NPOVLDMS
**(B)** NPOVPFOU
**(C)** LNMTLGMS
**(D)** NPOWLEOS

**Q.4**

Select the option in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following set. (25, 17, 170)

**(A)** (23, 18, 421)
**(B)** (49, 20, 140)
**(C)** (24, 60, 240)
**(D)** (36, 12, 144)

**Q.5**

Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. 59, 59, 61, 183, 187, ?

**(A)** 935
**(B)** 632
**(C)** 876
**(D)** 705

**Q.6**

Four words have been given, out of which three are alike in some manner and one is different. Select the word that is different.

**(A)** Flute
**(B)** Saxophone
**(C)** Mandolin
**(D)** Clarinet

**Q.7**

Select the option that is related to the third term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term. SHOVEL : MFWPIT : : NOVICE : ?

**(A)** OPWJDF
**(B)** WPOHBD
**(C)** FDJWPO
**(D)** MNUHBD

**Q.8**

What was the day of the week on 31 January 2009?

**(A)** Saturday
**(B)** Sunday
**(C)** Monday
**(D)** Friday

**Q.9**

Four number-pairs have been given, out of which three are alike in some manner and one is different. Select the number-pair that is different.

**(A)** 30 : 225
**(B)** 24 : 130
**(C)** 20 : 100
**(D)** 14 : 49

**Q.10**

Select the correct option that indicates the arrangement of the given words in the order in which they appear in an English dictionary. 1. Ruthless 2. Ruler 3. Routine 4. Rusticate 5. Rugby

**(A)** 3, 5, 2, 1, 4
**(B)** 3, 2, 5, 4, 1
**(C)** 3, 5, 2, 4, 1
**(D)** 5, 3, 2, 4, 1

**Q.11**

Which two signs should be interchanged to make the given equation correct? 45 – 49 + 26 × 70 ÷ 35 = 42

**(A)** ÷ and ×
**(B)** × and –
**(C)** + and ×
**(D)** + and –

**Q.12**

Four letter-clusters have been given, out of which three are alike in some manner and one is different. Select the letter-cluster that is different.

**(A)** EBCD
**(B)** NKLM
**(C)** IFGH
**(D)** WXYZ

**Q.13**

Select the option in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following set. (16, 60, 240)

**(A)** (16, 38, 260)
**(B)** (14, 42, 196)
**(C)** (18, 56, 252)
**(D)** (20, 12, 121)

**Q.14**

Select the combination of letters that when sequentially placed in the blanks of the given series will complete the series. p _ t b c p r _ b c _ r t b _ p _ t _ c

**(A)** r, c, p, b, t, r
**(B)** r, p, c, t, b, r
**(C)** r, t, p, c, r, b
**(D)** r, p, t, r, b, c

**Q.18**

Select the option that is related to the fourth number in the same way as the first number is related to the second number and the fifth number is related to the sixth number. 24 : 144 : : ? : 174 : : 35 : 210

**(A)** 29
**(B)** 38
**(C)** 33
**(D)** 27

**Q.20**

If Aniket is the brother of the son of Priyanka's son, then how is Aniket related to Priyanka?

**(A)** Grandson
**(B)** Son
**(C)** Cousin
**(D)** Brother

**Q.23**

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: Some balls are spoons. All stones are balls. No ball is a pebble. Conclusions: I. Some balls are stones. II. No spoon is a stone. III. No stone is a pebble.

**(A)** Only conclusion III follows.
**(B)** Both conclusions I and III follow.
**(C)** Both conclusions I and II follow.
**(D)** Both conclusions II and III follow.

**Q.24**

In a certain code language, 'TOPPER' is coded as '66' and 'MARK' is coded as '61'. How will 'INDUCE' be coded in that language?

**(A)** 86
**(B)** 106
**(C)** 100
**(D)** 96

**Q.25**

Select the option in which the words share the same relationship as that shared by the given pair of words. Libya : Tripoli

**(A)** Kampala : Uganda
**(B)** Harare : Zimbabwe
**(C)** Zambia : Lusaka
**(D)** Afghanistan : Jakarta

## General Awareness 25 questions

**Q.1**

Which of the following mountain passes is situated in the state of Uttarakhand?

**(A)** Nathu La Pass
**(B)** Baralacha La Pass
**(C)** Bomdi La Pass
**(D)** Mangsha Dhura Pass

**Q.2**

Who was appointed as UNICEF's celebrity advocate for a children's rights campaign in September 2020?

**(A)** Aamir Khan
**(B)** Nawazuddin Siddiqui
**(C)** Ayushmann Khurrana
**(D)** Akshay Kumar

**Q.3**

'PVC' is a high strength thermoplastic material widely used in applications, such as pipes, medical devices, wire and cable insulation. What is the full form of PVC?

**(A)** Polyvinyl Carbazole
**(B)** Polyvinyl Chloride
**(C)** Polyvinyl Calcium
**(D)** Polyvinyl Carbonate

**Q.4**

After over 21 years stay in South Africa, Gandhiji returned to India in _____.

**(A)** 1915
**(B)** 1916
**(C)** 1917
**(D)** 1919

**Q.5**

What was India's rank in the World Press Freedom Index 2020?

**(A)** 92
**(B)** 139
**(C)** 142
**(D)** 97

**Q.6**

The nephron is the microscopic structural and functional unit of the:

**(A)** kidney
**(B)** heart
**(C)** lung
**(D)** liver

**Q.7**
National Highway No. 7 connects:

**(A)** Fazilka to Mana
**(B)** Kashmir to Kanyakumari
**(C)** Varanasi to Kanyakumari
**(D)** Kanpur to Silchar

**Q.8**
To which country does the French Open 2020 women's singles winner, Iga Swiatek belong?

**(A)** China
**(B)** France
**(C)** Poland
**(D)** Japan

**Q.9**
Which of the following diseases damages the eye's optic nerve and results in vision loss and blindness and occurs when the normal fluid pressure inside the eyes slowly rises?

**(A)** Vitiligo
**(B)** Psoriasis
**(C)** Gonorrhoea
**(D)** Glaucoma

**Q.10**
India's first lithium refinery, which will process lithium ore to produce battery-grade material, will be set up in:

**(A)** Uttar Pradesh
**(B)** Rajasthan
**(C)** Madhya Pradesh
**(D)** Gujarat

**Q.11**
The 'Hornbill Festival' is a celebration held every year from 1 to 10 December in _____.

**(A)** Haryana
**(B)** Kerala
**(C)** Nagaland
**(D)** Uttarakhand

**Q.12**
In which of the following states is Neora Valley National Park situated?

**(A)** Maharashtra
**(B)** Kerala
**(C)** Himachal Pradesh
**(D)** West Bengal

**Q.13**
Which of the following organisations was awarded with the Nobel Peace Prize 2020?

**(A)** World Health Organization
**(B)** World Trade Organization
**(C)** World Food Programme
**(D)** International Labour Organization

**Q.14**
Who is the Chief Justice of Bangladesh as of May 2020?

**(A)** Abdul Hamid
**(B)** Syed Mahmud Hossain
**(C)** Narender Batra
**(D)** Sheikh Hasina

**Q.15**
Which of the following writs is a challenge to the legality of a prisoner's detention?

**(A)** Mandamus
**(B)** Quo Warranto
**(C)** Habeas corpus
**(D)** Prohibition

**Q.16**
Which of the following Hindu festivals is celebrated in the last month of the Hindu calendar?

**(A)** Holi
**(B)** Diwali
**(C)** Raksha Bandhan
**(D)** Makara Sankranti

**Q.17**
The Battle of Bedara was fought between the British Army and the Dutch Army in:

**(A)** 1760
**(B)** 1759
**(C)** 1772
**(D)** 1764

**Q.18**
Who among the following won the 'Tenzing Norgay National Adventure Award' in August 2020 in the 'Water Adventure' category?

**(A)** Satyendra Singh
**(B)** Narendra Singh
**(C)** Sarfaraz Singh
**(D)** Anita Devi

**Q.19**
Which of the following is an open source operating system?

**(A)** Windows 10
**(B)** Windows Vista
**(C)** Android
**(D)** iOS

**Q.20**
Which of the following is the correct definition of bank rate?

**(A)** It is the rate of interest payable by commercial banks to RBI.
**(B)** It is the rate of interest payable by a scheduled bank at which RBI lends overnight.
**(C)** It is the rate of interest payable by a consumer to commercial banks.
**(D)** It is the rate of interest payable by RBI to commercial banks.

**Q.21**
Which of the following is an input device used to verify the legitimacy or originality of paper documents, especially cheques?

**(A)** Non-impact printer
**(B)** Optical mark reader
**(C)** Electronic card reader
**(D)** Magnetic ink character recognition

**Q.22**
Chulia waterfall is situated on Chambal River in _____.

**(A)** Uttar Pradesh
**(B)** Gujarat
**(C)** Rajasthan
**(D)** Madhya Pradesh

**Q.23**
In which of the following states was the Monpa handmade paper making unit inaugurated in December 2020?

**(A)** Tripura
**(B)** Assam
**(C)** Arunachal Pradesh
**(D)** Manipur

**Q.24**
Who among the following was the first female hockey player to have won the Rajiv Gandhi Khel Ratna Award?

**(A)** Gurjit Kaur
**(B)** Reena Khokhar
**(C)** Rani Rampal
**(D)** Lilima Minz

**Q.25**
In the Union Budget 2020-21, the Government of India proposed to spend ₹30,42,230 crore in 2020-21, which is _____ higher than the revised estimate of 2019-20.

**(A)** 12.7%
**(B)** 18.9%
**(C)** 18.7%
**(D)** 17.6%

# Answer key

### English Language

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Q.1 **(C)** | Q.2 **(B)** | Q.3 **(B)** | Q.4 **(D)** | Q.5 **(B)** | Q.6 **(C)** |
| Q.8 **(A)** | Q.9 **(A)** | Q.10 **(B)** | Q.11 **(B)** | Q.12 **(C)** | Q.13 **(C)** |
| Q.14 **(A)** | Q.15 **(C)** | Q.16 **(B)** | Q.17 **(B)** | Q.18 **(A)** | Q.19 **(B)** |
| Q.20 **(C)** | Q.21 **(A)** | Q.22 **(B)** | Q.23 **(B)** | Q.24 **(D)** | Q.25 **(A)** |

### General Intelligence

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Q.1 **(A)** | Q.4 **(D)** | Q.5 **(A)** | Q.6 **(C)** | Q.7 **(C)** | Q.8 **(A)** |
| Q.9 **(B)** | Q.10 **(C)** | Q.11 **(D)** | Q.12 **(D)** | Q.13 **(C)** | Q.14 **(C)** |
| Q.18 **(A)** | Q.20 **(A)** | Q.23 **(B)** | Q.24 **(C)** | Q.25 **(C)** | |

### General Awareness

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Q.1 **(D)** | Q.2 **(C)** | Q.3 **(B)** | Q.4 **(A)** | Q.5 **(C)** | Q.6 **(A)** |
| Q.7 **(A)** | Q.8 **(C)** | Q.9 **(D)** | Q.10 **(D)** | Q.11 **(C)** | Q.12 **(D)** |
| Q.13 **(C)** | Q.14 **(B)** | Q.15 **(C)** | Q.16 **(A)** | Q.17 **(B)** | Q.18 **(A)** |
| Q.19 **(C)** | Q.20 **(A)** | Q.21 **(D)** | Q.22 **(C)** | Q.23 **(C)** | Q.24 **(C)** |
| Q.25 **(A)** | | | | | |

## Explanations

### English Language

**Q.1 · Answer (C) Unpretensious**

The correct spelling is 'unpretentious'.

**Q.2 · Answer (B) CBAD**

C says light was created twice, B gives the first time, A ('This cooled off') follows the glowing fireball and D gives the second time: CBAD.

**Q.3 · Answer (B) The new employee asked the manager when he had to report for work.**

A reported question keeps 'asked', drops the question form and moves the tense back: 'asked the manager when he had to report for work'.

**Q.4 · Answer (D) Shocking**

'Appalling' means causing shock or dismay: 'shocking'.

**Q.5 · Answer (B) let us go**

'Let' takes an object pronoun: 'let us go', not 'let we go'. (The sheet's underline also takes in 'home', which the options leave out.)

**Q.6 · Answer (C) accompany**

Gestures and body language go along with, or 'accompany', the spoken words.

**Q.8 · Answer (A) The police rescued fifteen children from an unregistered home.**

The agent, 'the police', becomes the subject and 'were rescued' becomes the simple past active 'rescued': 'The police rescued fifteen children from an unregistered home.'

**Q.9 · Answer (A) To take advantage of a difficult situation**

To 'fish in troubled waters' is to take advantage of a confused or difficult situation for one's own gain.

**Q.10 · Answer (B) CBDA**

C introduces the values civil servants need, B gives the first (transparency), D the next (the public interest) and A explains what D means: CBDA.

**Q.11 · Answer (B) Bright**

'Gloomy' means dark or sad; its opposite is 'bright'. 'Dull' and 'dismal' are close in meaning to 'gloomy'.

**Q.12 · Answer (C) Path**

A 'trail' is a track: a 'path'. 'Rehearsal' would suit 'trial', a test run, which is a different word.

**Q.13 · Answer (C) we couldn’t be able to**

'Could' already expresses ability, so 'couldn't be able to' says it twice: 'we couldn't score high' or 'we were not able to score high'.

**Q.14 · Answer (A) Flick**

A 'flick' is a quick, sudden movement, as of the wrist. A fleck or a speck is a small spot.

**Q.15 · Answer (C) are allowed**

SSC's key gives 'are allowed', on the rule that a plural amount of time taken as one quantity takes a singular verb: 'Only five minutes is allowed for each speaker'. The other three parts are correct.

**Q.16 · Answer (B) Polite**

'Curt' means rudely brief; its opposite is 'polite'.

**Q.17 · Answer (B) must return**

'Return' already means give back, so 'return back' is redundant: 'You must return the book'.

**Q.18 · Answer (A) Thoroughfare**

A 'thoroughfare' is a main road open to public traffic.

**Q.19 · Answer (B) devised**
SSC's key gives 'devised': to devise is to work out or plan, and the conditions and procedures are the states' own. 'Adopted' could also be argued, though one usually adopts something that already exists; 'insisted' would need 'on', and 'accepted' does not fit rules a state draws up itself.

**Q.20 · Answer (C) At a very short distance**
'At a stone's throw' means at a very short distance.

**Q.21 · Answer (A) Where**
The question asks about a destination: 'Where will humans go after they have explored our solar system?'

**Q.22 · Answer (B) answer**
To 'hold the answer to' these questions is to contain their answer.

**Q.23 · Answer (B) possible**
Travel to other galaxies will only be 'possible' in huge starships.

**Q.24 · Answer (D) population**
Each starship will carry a large human 'population', some of whom will settle on a new planet.

**Q.25 · Answer (A) distant**
Life on Earth would become just a 'distant' memory, one far back in the past.

### General Intelligence

**Q.1 · Answer (A) NPOVLDMS**
The first four letters move one place forward and the last four one place back: UMBR → VNCS and ELLA → DKKZ. So MONU → NPOV and MENT → LDMS: NPOVLDMS.

**Q.4 · Answer (D) (36, 12, 144)**
The third number is the second times twice the square root of the first: 17 × (2 × 5) = 170. Likewise 12 × (2 × 6) = 144.

**Q.5 · Answer (A) 935**
The steps are ×1, +2, ×3, +4, ×5 in turn: 59, 59, 61, 183, 187, and 187 × 5 = 935.

**Q.6 · Answer (C) Mandolin**
The mandolin is a stringed instrument; the flute, saxophone and clarinet are wind instruments.

**Q.7 · Answer (C) FDJWPO**
SHOVEL written backwards is LEVOHS, and each letter then moves one place forward: MFWPIT. NOVICE backwards is ECIVON, which becomes FDJWPO.

**Q.8 · Answer (A) Saturday**
1 January 2001 was a Monday. 2001 to 2008 add 8 + 2 (the leap years 2004 and 2008) = 10 odd days, that is 3, so 1 January 2009 was a Thursday. 30 days later (2 odd days) is a Saturday.

**Q.9 · Answer (B) 24 : 130**
In 30 : 225, 20 : 100 and 14 : 49 the second number is the square of half the first: $15^2$, $10^2$ and $7^2$. Half of 24 is 12, and $12^2 = 144$, not 130.

**Q.10 · Answer (C) 3, 5, 2, 4, 1**
Routine (Ro-) comes first; the rest begin 'Ru' and go by their third letter: Rugby (g), Ruler (l), Rusticate (s), Ruthless (t). So 3, 5, 2, 4, 1.

**Q.11 · Answer (D) + and –**
After interchanging + and –: 45 + 49 – 26 × 70 ÷ 35 = 45 + 49 – 52 = 42.

**Q.12 · Answer (D) WXYZ**
In EBCD, NKLM and IFGH the second letter is 3 places before the first, and the rest follow it in order. WXYZ runs straight through, so it is the odd one.

**Q.13 · Answer (C) (18, 56, 252)**
The third number is the first times a quarter of the second: 16 × (60 ÷ 4) = 240. Likewise 18 × (56 ÷ 4) = 252.

**Q.14 · Answer (C) r, t, p, c, r, b**
With r, t, p, c, r, b in the blanks the block prtbc repeats: prtbc prtbc prtbc prtbc.

**Q.18 · Answer (A) 29**
The second number is six times the first: 24 × 6 = 144 and 35 × 6 = 210. So ? × 6 = 174 and ? = 29.

**Q.20 · Answer (A) Grandson**
The son of Priyanka's son is her grandson, and Aniket, his brother, is her grandson too.

**Q.23 · Answer (B) Both conclusions I and III follow.**
All stones are balls, so some balls are stones (I); and as no ball is a pebble, no stone is a pebble (III). Nothing links spoons to stones, so II does not follow.

**Q.24 · Answer (C) 100**
Each letter counts as 26 minus its place in the alphabet, and the code is the sum: TOPPER = 6 + 11 + 10 + 10 + 21 + 8 = 66 and MARK = 13 + 25 + 8 + 15 = 61. INDUCE = 17 + 12 + 22 + 5 + 23 + 21 = 100.

**Q.25 · Answer (C) Zambia : Lusaka**
Tripoli is the capital of Libya, so the pair is country : capital, as in Zambia : Lusaka. Kampala : Uganda and Harare : Zimbabwe put the capital first, and Jakarta is the capital of Indonesia.

### General Awareness

**Q.1 · Answer (D) Mangsha Dhura Pass**
Mangsha Dhura, in Pithoragarh district, links Uttarakhand with Tibet. Nathu La is in Sikkim, Baralacha La in Himachal Pradesh and Bomdi La in Arunachal Pradesh.

**Q.2 · Answer (C) Ayushmann Khurrana**
Ayushmann Khurrana became UNICEF's celebrity advocate for its campaign on children's rights in September 2020.

**Q.3 · Answer (B) Polyvinyl Chloride**
PVC is polyvinyl chloride, a polymer of vinyl chloride.

**Q.4 · Answer (A) 1915**
Gandhiji returned from South Africa in January 1915, landing at Bombay on 9 January, the day now marked as Pravasi Bharatiya Divas.

**Q.5 · Answer (C) 142**
India ranked 142nd of 180 countries in Reporters Without Borders' World Press Freedom Index 2020.

**Q.6 · Answer (A) kidney**
The nephron, of which each kidney has about a million, filters the blood and forms urine.

**Q.7 · Answer (A) Fazilka to Mana**
NH 7 runs from Fazilka in Punjab, near the Pakistan border, to Mana in Uttarakhand, near the Tibet border. Varanasi–Kanyakumari was NH 7 only under the numbering replaced in 2010; that road now carries other numbers, mostly NH 44.

**Q.8 · Answer (C) Poland**
Iga Swiatek of Poland won the 2020 French Open women's singles, Poland's first Grand Slam singles title.

**Q.9 · Answer (D) Glaucoma**
Glaucoma damages the optic nerve, usually as the pressure inside the eye builds up, and can lead to blindness. Vitiligo and psoriasis are skin disorders and gonorrhoea is a sexually transmitted infection.

**Q.10 · Answer (D) Gujarat**
Manikaran Power, with Australia's Neometals, planned India's first lithium refinery in Gujarat, to turn imported ore into battery-grade lithium hydroxide.

**Q.11 · Answer (C) Nagaland**
Nagaland holds the Hornbill Festival every year from 1 to 10 December at Kisama, near Kohima.

**Q.12 · Answer (D) West Bengal**
Neora Valley National Park lies in Kalimpong district, in northern West Bengal.

**Q.13 · Answer (C) World Food Programme**
The World Food Programme won the 2020 Nobel Peace Prize for its efforts to combat hunger.

**Q.14 · Answer (B) Syed Mahmud Hossain**
Syed Mahmud Hossain was Chief Justice of Bangladesh from February 2018 to December 2021. Abdul Hamid was the President and Sheikh Hasina the Prime Minister.

**Q.15 · Answer (C) Habeas corpus**
Habeas corpus ('you may have the body') orders a detained person to be brought before the court, which then tests whether the detention is lawful.

**Q.16 · Answer (A) Holi**
Holi falls on the full moon of Phalguna, the last month of the Hindu lunar calendar, which begins with Chaitra.

**Q.17 · Answer (B) 1759**
The Battle of Bedara (Chinsurah), in November 1759, ended the Dutch challenge to the British in Bengal.

**Q.18 · Answer (A) Satyendra Singh**
Para-swimmer Satyendra (Satendra) Singh Lohiya of Madhya Pradesh received the Tenzing Norgay National Adventure Award for 2019, announced in August 2020, for water adventure.

**Q.19 · Answer (C) Android**
Android is built on the Linux kernel and released as open source through the Android Open Source Project; Windows and iOS are proprietary.

**Q.20 · Answer (A) It is the rate of interest payable by commercial banks to RBI.**
Bank rate is the rate at which RBI lends to commercial banks, by rediscounting their bills of exchange, so it is the interest the banks pay RBI. Overnight lending to banks is at the repo and MSF rates.

**Q.21 · Answer (D) Magnetic ink character recognition**
Magnetic ink character recognition (MICR) reads the magnetic-ink characters printed along the foot of a cheque, letting banks verify and process cheques.

**Q.22 · Answer (C) Rajasthan**
Chulia Falls is on the Chambal near Rawatbhata, in Chittorgarh district, Rajasthan.

**Q.23 · Answer (C) Arunachal Pradesh**
In December 2020 the KVIC opened a Monpa handmade paper unit in Tawang, Arunachal Pradesh, reviving a craft about 1,000 years old used for Buddhist scriptures.

**Q.24 · Answer (C) Rani Rampal**
Rani Rampal received the Rajiv Gandhi Khel Ratna in 2020, the first woman hockey player to win it.

**Q.25 · Answer (A) 12.7%**
The Budget of February 2020 put the revised estimate of spending for 2019-20 at about ₹26.99 lakh crore, and 30.42 ÷ 26.99 ≈ 1.127: a rise of 12.7%.

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